

cially after a natural disaster. Not really cool, whichever way you look at it. There are many websites which exclusively offer free education about fraudulent attempts on the internet. The Anti-Phishing Working Group offers information and the latest reports on attacks.

Many email providers have an option that lets you report suspicious emails and phishing scams. Reporting such incidences can help prevent receiving more such emails; especially with the abuse team working extra hard to stop similar attempts in the future.

Most scams are usually alarming messages which threaten of account closure. Never pay attention to them. Also, phishing scams start off with promises of money in a business proposition or through deals that sound too good to be true. Most of these mails are badly written with pathetic grammar and wrong spellings. Though not a sure shot way to spot phishing but can be a handy marker at times. If you come across such badly written email, never respond to them. If you are in doubt of such a mail, make a call to the telephone number given to check the authenticity of the claim. If there's no number, don't even bother.

To your credit

Credit cards are major sources of cybercrime and can be easily tampered with, if you are not careful enough with it. A stolen credit card can mean

the end of the world. So, it is important that you treat your credit card as carefully as cash.



Keep your card details, like the card number and CVV confidential.

If you get a new credit card, immediately sign at the back with permanent ink. If you still have old credit cards that have expired, cut them up to reduce the possibility of a misuse.

While swiping your card at stores, wait till the transaction has been completed. Check if the card returned to you was the one you had given and has not been tampered with in any way. This may seem like inconsequential but most cybercrimes are a result of negligence on the part of the user. So when you get the charge slip, total the amount to make sure that you are